



Your money waits until the house is actually there.

Datum holds the money you put into a home in escrow, in shillings, and releases it to the builder one stage at a time. Photos of the site have to pass four checks and a trustee has to sign. If the site goes quiet, your money comes back.

Daniel Mwihoti and Soni Mwangi · datum-roan.vercel.app · Avalanche Pitch Perfect, September 2026

THE PROBLEM

We all know someone who paid and got nothing.

The off-plan buyer

You pay a deposit, then instalments, straight into the developer's account. Two years later the site is still a fence and a signboard. There is nobody to call and no money to get back.

The one sending money home

You are in Dubai or Doha or Dallas, sending 300k for a house on your own plot. What comes back is photos on WhatsApp. Whose plot is that? When was that taken? Is that the same wall from last month? By the time you know, the money is gone.

Both of you trusted a stranger with money and got a promise back. No bank, no insurer, no court can help you afterwards.

WHAT DATUM DOES

Nothing moves until there is proof.

1 · Real people

You sign in with your M-Pesa number or your email and get your own Avalanche address. Anyone who wants to list or build pays KES 200 and our staff go and verify them in person.

2 · Money goes into escrow

You pay by M-Pesa, as always. Each payment becomes a claim in a smart contract, in shillings. The builder cannot touch it. Not us either.

3 · Photos are checked

Taken at your plot. Taken this month. Never sent before. Showing the stage they say it is. Then a trustee looks at the same photos and signs.

4 · Paid stage by stage

Two of three signatures release one stage's share, nothing more. Thirty quiet days and anyone can call it stalled; what was never released comes back to everyone, fairly.

THE PRODUCT

One page that shows where every shilling is.

The drawdown register. What is held, what has been released, against which photos, signed by whom. The same page a bank would want, and anyone can open it.

Every release links to the photos that earned it, the hash on chain, and the transaction.

Drawdown register

Project Willow Park Block A, Kilimanjaro Status Active Ledger 0x5bd2bad8... Operator sign out Sender page ...

Off-plan buyers in Kenya pay for homes that do not exist yet. The money goes into a developer's account, and if the build stalls there is no way to get it back. Datum holds those deposits in escrow and releases them only against construction that has been proven to exist.

1 - BUYERS PAY IN

Deposits arrive by M-Pesa and are held by a smart contract, denominated in shillings. The developer cannot touch them.

2 - THE SITE IS PHOTOGRAPHED

Each milestone needs geotagged photographs. Four checks run on every one: it was taken at the site, taken recently, never submitted before, and shows the stage claimed.

3 - TWO OF THREE SIGN

The evidence pipeline is one signature. A licensed surveyor, the person whose money it is, or the platform is the second. No single party, including us, can move money alone.

4 - OR EVERYONE IS REFUNDED

If the project goes quiet for 30 days, any buyer can declare it stalled. Whatever was never released comes back, pro rata, no matter who claims first.

Milestone schedule

Funds release only against verified evidence

01 20%	02 40%	03 60%	04 80%	05 100%
Site clearing and foundation 1 of 2 signed	Ground floor slab	First floor structure	Roofing complete	Finishing and handover

Buyer deposits

KES 650

Still protected

KES 650

Released to developer

KES 0

Verified milestones

0 / 5

1 - Site evidence

BUILDER

The builder submits three geotagged photographs of the current stage. Location, recency, novelty and stage are checked before anything moves.

Photographs

Choose Files | No file chosen

Submit for verification

2 - Countersign

TWO OF THREE REQUIRED

The evidence pipeline is one attester. The sender, 254722114050, approves from their own page; the platform can countersign instead if they ask us to.

Platform confirms

If the builder walks away

Unreleased funds are returned pro rata. Claim order changes nothing.

Verification result

SITE CLEARING AND FOUNDATION

Evidence rejected

1 of 1 images passed, 3 required.

foundation_4.jpg

location recent not reused stage match

Within 0m of the registered site · Captured 3 days ago · Shows foundation (100% confidence)

Bundle hash 0x4c4e7d0b6301e3903b7f8eb732779466733b2013423317b8f80cF5456a91d22a

Public record check

BACKSTREET HOMES LTD

Photographs prove what the camera saw. Public records prove the company still exists.

Developer

Willow Park Developments Ltd

YOUR APPROVAL IS NEEDED

GROUND FLOOR SLAB

The builder says this milestone is done and the photographs passed every check.
Nothing is released until you say so — look at them and decide.



AT YOUR PLOT

RECENT

NOT SENT BEFORE

STAGE MATCHES

Within 0m of the registered site · Captured 2 days ago ·
Shows ground slab (100% confidence)



AT YOUR PLOT

RECENT

NOT SENT BEFORE

STAGE MATCHES

Within 0m of the registered site · Captured 2 days ago ·
Shows ground slab (100% confidence)



AT YOUR PLOT

RECENT

NOT SENT BEFORE

STAGE MATCHES

Within 0m of the registered site · Captured 2 days ago ·
Shows ground slab (100% confidence)

Approve and release

Not satisfied

Approving releases only this milestone's share. The rest of your
money stays in escrow until the next stage is proven.

THE PART THAT MATTERS

You hold a signature. From wherever you are.

If it is your money, you approve each stage from the photos, on your phone. The fundi cannot release money alone. Neither can we.

Wrong plot, old photo, recycled photo, wrong stage: each one is thrown out before a human even looks.

OR START WITH US

Tell us what to build. We find the fundi.

1 · Ask

Say what you want built, where, and your budget. Pay a ten percent initial deposit by M-Pesa. We hold it as your claim.

2 · We propose

Our staff pick a builder we have verified and a trustee, set the price and the stages, and send you the agreement.

3 · Both sign

You sign. The builder signs. Each signature is written on chain from your own address.

4 · Building starts

The second signature creates the escrow with your deposit already inside it. From here it is stage, photos, trustee, release.

Live today: an owner asked, staff proposed, both parties signed, and the escrow deployed itself with the deposit inside, all on Avalanche.

WHO IT IS FOR

We start with the diaspora. The pain is sharpest and the sale is cleanest.

Kenyans abroad

Sending 300k to 3M over a few years to a relative or a fundi they cannot supervise. They already pay to send money. They will pay to know it is safe.

Off-plan buyers

People in Nairobi and the satellite towns who have heard the stories and want proof before each instalment.

Developers and companies

Good ones lose sales to distrust. "Your money is in escrow, not with us" is the best sales line they will ever have.

Trustees

Surveyors, valuers and advocates who already visit sites and would like a paid, permanent record of what they signed off.

HOW WE MAKE MONEY

The people who want the certainty pay for it.

Onboarding fee, live today

KES 200

On each stage released

1 to 1.5%

Verification visit, per listing

flat fee

Developers with several projects

monthly

On a 3M build the sender pays 200 bob once and 30k to 45k over the whole build. That is less than one flight home to check. Our cost is a few Avalanche transactions and one trustee visit per stage, which the visit fee pays for. Only the KES 200 is charged today; the rest is the plan.

WHERE WE ARE

Three weeks of building. It is live, and it has moved real money.

Escrows on Avalanche

4

Actions written on chain

every one

Whole lifecycle proven

in → release →
refund

Tests passing

48 + 9

Real

- Live on Vercel, on Avalanche Fuji
- Real M-Pesa sandbox payments landing in escrow
- Three contracts, open source

Tried end to end

- Every photo check, with real Kenyan site photos
- Accounts in every role, verified on chain
- Listings live, a build agreed and signed by both sides

Not yet

- Paying customers
- A licensed partner to hold the shillings
- Production M-Pesa

WHY AVALANCHE

Rules nobody at Datum can bend, at a cost nobody notices.

The rules are code

Two of three signatures. Stage by stage. Fair refunds. Not a policy we promise to follow: a contract anyone can read and nobody can quietly change.

A record you can take to a bank

Everything everyone did, hashed against their own address. Your trace is evidence, not a screenshot.

Cents and seconds

A build is dozens of transactions. On Avalanche they cost cents and settle in seconds, which is what someone abroad waiting on a release needs.

Your name, number, email and ID never touch the chain. They stay in our database under the Data Protection Act. The chain only ever sees addresses and hashes.

TEAM

Two founders

Daniel Mwihoti

FOUNDER • PRODUCT AND ENGINEERING

Built the contracts, the photo checks with their own perceptual hash, the M-Pesa integration and the app.

danielmwihoti@gmail.com

Soni Mwangi

CO-FOUNDER

Partnerships and the ground game: trustees, builders, diaspora networks, and the visits that make a listing worth trusting.

WHAT WE NEED, AND HOW TO TRY IT

Four introductions. One scan.

A licensed trust or e-money partner. A production M-Pesa paybill. Three developers and one diaspora SACCO to pilot. Surveyors and valuers to be our trustees.

Scan, pick who you are, sign in with any number or email and the code **246810**.
datum-roan.vercel.app · github.com/Talent-Index/datum

